

Formal Boys Baseball Opening Set

Some 1500 potential major leaguers of the future will gather for formal opening ceremonies of the 19th season of Boys Baseball of El Paso at 6:15 p.m. Friday at Memorial Park.

Gene Stogner, athletic director for the City Parks and Recreation Department will serve as master of ceremonies for the event. Stogner said that the public is invited, and particularly the parents and friends of the youngsters involved.

Boys Baseball will field 96 teams this year in major and minor league competition. Boys 11 and 12 will play in the majors, and the minor leagues will be made up of boys 8 through 10 years of age.

Andy Cohen, one of El Paso's few ex-major leaguers and now coach of the U.T. El Paso baseball team, will be guest speaker at Friday evening's ceremonies. Others on the program include Larry Welsh, commissioner of Boys Baseball; Art Ranew, executive director of the program, and his assistant, Al Sepkowitz; and Rev. Harland M. Irvin, Jr., who will give the invocation.

Two abbreviated exhibition games will follow the formal opening ceremonies. A three-inning minor league contest will be staged between Magoffin School, sponsored by Downtown Lions, and Bassett School, sponsored by Lee and Scott Insurance Co.